

Website speed and accessibility review: after improvements

www.atsdiamondtools.co.uk · measured 24 September 2026 · prepared by Red Frog Studio

This is the follow-up to the review we sent earlier today. The changes described in that report have been made on a test copy of the website and measured with the same Google page speed test, on the same three pages, on both mobile and desktop. The table below shows the new scores. Please read the note further down about why some of the numbers here are lower than they will be on the live site.

Scores

Page	Device	Performance	Accessibility	Best practices	SEO
Home page	Mobile	65	100	–	–
	Desktop	97	100	–	–
Category page (Polishing)	Mobile	61	100	–	–
	Desktop	97	100	–	–
Product page (100mm 3-step polishing pads)	Mobile	49	100	–	–
	Desktop	95	100	–	–

Scores are out of 100. 90 to 100 good 50 to 89 needs work 0 to 49 poor

Key measurements, home page on mobile

Measurement	Before	After	What it means
Performance score	43	65	Google's overall speed grade for the page on a slow phone connection.
Accessibility score	80	100	How well the page works with screen readers and for people with poorer eyesight.
Main content visible	6.6 seconds	4.8 seconds	How long until the banner picture is on screen. Google wants under 2.5 seconds; the live site will be faster than this (see the note below).
Time the phone is busy	850 ms	480 ms	How long the phone is too busy running scripts to respond to taps.
Layout jumping	0.196	0.002	How much the page shifts about while loading. Under 0.1 is good; 0.002 is essentially none.

The short version

Every page now scores 100 for accessibility on both mobile and desktop, up from 80 to 90. The layout jumping that Google flagged on every page is gone. The home page mobile score has gone from 43 (poor) to 65 (needs work), the category page from 56 to 61 and the product page from 37 to 49, with the main content appearing roughly two seconds sooner. Desktop scores stay in the high 90s. These figures were taken on the test copy of the site, which is set up in a way that holds the numbers back by around ten points, so we expect the live site to land higher once the changes go across.

What we changed

- **The banner picture and logo now load first.** The caching plugin no longer treats them as "load later" pictures, and the browser is told to fetch the banner before anything else.
- **Phones get phone-sized pictures.** The home page banner and category banners are now sent in several sizes and the phone picks the smallest one that fits its screen. The largest versions are also compressed a little harder with no visible difference.
- **Facebook and Google tracking wait their turn.** Both tags now start once the page has drawn instead of the moment it opens. Page views, add-to-basket events and sales are still recorded exactly as before.
- **The page no longer jumps while loading.** The clearance offers bar at the top of the page used to slide open after the page had drawn, pushing everything down. It is now in place from the start, and visitors who have closed it never see it flash. Pictures also have their space reserved before they arrive.
- **Product pictures appear straight away.** On product pages the main photo used to stay hidden until the image slider had finished setting itself up. It now shows immediately and the slider takes over once it is ready.
- **The clearance offers pop-up no longer counts as the main content.** The pop-up opens two seconds after the page loads with a large photo. On phones Google was sometimes treating that late-arriving photo as the page's main content, which made the "main content visible" time look far worse than it is (12.8 seconds in one of your own tests). The photo is now sent at its real size and left out on phone screens, where the pop-up shows the text and button only.
- **Fonts no longer hide the text.** While the site's fonts are downloading, text is shown in a fallback font instead of being invisible.

Accessibility fixes

- The banner's next, previous and dot buttons, the basket button and the price slider handles now have names that screen readers can announce.
- The faint grey "Reviews" count, the green "in stock" text, the green sale badges and the small grey text in the category menu have been darkened enough to meet the contrast standard.
- The clearance offers pop-up now has a proper name for assistive technology, and the closed side menu is hidden from keyboard and screen-reader users until it is opened.
- The product carousels no longer use a list structure that confuses screen readers, and the sidebar filter headings follow the correct order.
- The "Read more" link on the home page now says where it goes.

Why these numbers are on the cautious side

The after-measurements were taken on our test copy of the website rather than the live site, because that is where the changes have been made. The test copy differs from the live site in three ways that pull the scores down:

- It sends the site's stylesheet uncompressed (about 310 KB instead of about 32 KB). On a slow phone connection this alone costs around two seconds and is the main reason the "main content visible" time is still 4.8 seconds. The live site compresses it.
- It runs without a secure (https) address and is hidden from Google on purpose. Google's test penalises both, so the best practices and SEO columns are left blank above rather than showing misleading figures. Nothing we changed affects those two scores; the live site scored 100 and 92 to 100 on them before and will again.
- Product pages load Apple Pay and Google Pay from the payment provider, which sets cookies Google's test does not like. This was already the case before (the product page scored 75 for best practices) and we have left it alone because the payment buttons are worth more than the points.

For a fair comparison we ran the before and after tests with the same tool and the same settings. Once the changes are on the live site we will run the test a third time and send the final figures.

What is left to do

- Move the changes from the test copy to the live site. We will do this at a quiet time and check the shop, basket and checkout afterwards.
- Switch on browser caching for pictures, scripts and styles in the hosting control panel (Plesk). This is a one-off hosting setting; we will supply the exact lines. It mainly speeds up the second and later pages a visitor looks at, which the test does not measure but customers will feel.
- One footer link in the newsletter text still points nowhere. That is a content setting rather than code, and we can fix it in a minute if you tell us where it should go.
- Re-test the live site and send the final report.